
COUVENT SYRUP

1 Name of the medicinal product

COUVENT SYRUP

2 Qualitative and quantitative composition

Each 5ml contains 2 mg Salbutamol (as Salbutamol Sulphate), 4 mg Bromhexine Hydrochloride and 50 mg Guaifenesin.

Excipients with known effect:

Sodium Benzoate	10.0 mg/5ml
Propylene glycol	1.025 ml/5ml
Carmoisine Colour	0.15 mg/5ml

For the full list of excipients see section 6.1.

3 Pharmaceutical form

Oral Solution

Light pink colour liquid with cherry flavour

4 Clinical particulars

4.1 Therapeutic indications

COUVENT SYRUP is used for clearance of viscid purulent sputum in acute and chronic bronchitis and complicating conditions, bronchial asthma, bronchiectasis and whooping cough.

4.2 Posology and method of administration

Children 2 - 6 years: 1.25 to 2.5 ml orally, 3 to 4 times a day.

Children 6 - 12 years: 2.5 to 5ml orally, 3 to 4 times a day.

Adults: 5ml orally, 3 to 4 times a day.

Or as directed by the physician.

COUVENT SYRUP is not recommended for children under 2 years of age without medical advice.

Medical advice should be sought if the symptoms last longer than 14 days and/or if the symptoms increase in spite of treatment with COUVENT SYRUP.

4.3 Contraindications

Hypersensitivity to any of the ingredients, thyrotoxicosis, angina pectoris, severe cardiovascular diseases, peptic ulcers, pregnancy and breastfeeding.

4.4 Special warnings and precautions for use

Before taking COUVENT SYRUP, you must tell your doctor or pharmacist if you have, or have had, any of the following conditions: liver problems, kidney problems, stomach ulcers.

Before using COUVENT SYRUP, it is important to tell your doctor or pharmacist if you are taking any other medicines, obtained with or without a doctor's prescription.

Tocolysis: Serious adverse reactions including death have been reported after administration of terbutaline/ salbutamol to women in labor. In the mother, these include increased heart rate, transient hyperglycaemia, hypokalaemia, cardiac arrhythmias, pulmonary oedema and myocardia ischaemia. Increased fetal heart rate and neonatal hypoglycaemia may occur as a result of maternal administration.

Very rare cases of chronically associated severe skin impairments such as Stevens Johnson Syndrome, Toxic Epidermal Necrolysis (TEN), Erythema Multiforme (EM) and Acute Generalized Exanthematous Pustulosis (AGEP) have been reported. In most cases, these could be explained by the severity of the underlying disease or concomitant administration of another drug. In the early stages of such severe skin reactions, initially only nonspecific flu-like symptoms appear, e.g. fever, arthralgia, runny nose, cough, and sore throat. If skin or mucous membrane damage occurs, seek medical advice immediately and discontinue treatment as a precaution.

Excipients: Sodium Benzoate, Propylene glycol, Carmoisine Colour

Sodium Benzoate

This medicine contains 10.0 mg sodium benzoate in each 5ml which is equivalent to 2.0 mg/ml.

Sodium benzoate may increase jaundice (yellowing of the skin and eyes) in newborn babies (up to 4 weeks old).

Propylene glycol

This medicine contains 1.025 ml propylene glycol in each 5ml which is equivalent to 0.21 ml/ml.

If your baby is less than 4 weeks old, talk to your doctor or pharmacist before giving them this medicine, in particular if the baby is given other medicines that contain propylene glycol or alcohol.

If your child is less than 5 years old, talk to your doctor or pharmacist before giving them this medicine, in particular if they use other medicines that contain propylene glycol or alcohol.

If you are pregnant or breast-feeding, do not take this medicine unless recommended by your doctor. Your doctor may carry out extra checks while you are taking this medicine.

If you suffer from a liver or kidney disease, do not take this medicine unless recommended by your doctor. Your doctor may carry out extra checks while you are taking this medicine.

Propylene glycol in this medicine can have the same effects as drinking alcohol and increase the likelihood of side effects. Do not use this medicine in children less than 5 years old. Use this medicine only if recommended by a doctor. Your doctor may carry out extra checks while you are taking this medicine.

Carmoisine Colour

May cause allergic reactions.

4.5 Interaction with other medicinal products and other forms of interaction

It may enhance the sedative effect of central nervous system depressants including alcohol, barbiturates, hypnotics, narcotic analgesics, sedatives and tranquilisers.

4.6 Pregnancy and lactation

COUVENT SYRUP is expected to enter breast milk. Therefore, it is not recommended that COUVENT SYRUP be taken by woman who are breastfeeding.

4.7 Effects on ability to drive and use machines

None known.

4.8 Undesirable effects

Occasional, mild side effects from COUVENT SYRUP include:

- Upper gastrointestinal complaints like nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea, indigestion, a feeling of fullness in the stomach (a bloating feeling).
- Tachycardia, palpitation, precordial pain, nervousness, tremors in a few patients.

Immune System Disorders

Frequency not known: Anaphylactic reactions including anaphylactic shock.

Skin and Subcutaneous Skin Disorders

Frequency not known: Severe skin reactions (including Stevens Johnson syndrome, Toxic epidermal necrolysis (TEN), Erythema Multiforme (EM) and Acute Generalized Exanthematous Pustulosis (AGEP).

4.9 Overdose

In massive overdosage the stomach should be emptied (emesis and/or gastric lavage) and further absorption prevented. Treatment is symptomatic and supportive.

5 Pharmacological properties

5.1 Pharmacodynamic properties

Salbutamol is a synthetic sympathomimetic amine. Salbutamol stimulates beta-adrenergic receptors and has little or no effect on alpha adrenergic receptors. Beta-adrenergic agonists stimulate the production of cyclic adenosine-3',5'-monophosphate(AMP) by activation of the enzyme adenylyl cyclase.

Cyclic AMP appears to have greater stimulating effect on beta receptors of the bronchial, uterine and vascular smooth muscles (beta-1 receptors).

Bromhexine is a mucolytic agent used in the treatment of respiratory disorders associated with viscid or excessive mucus.

The expectorant, guaifenesin, is employed to produce a thinning of mucous secretions increasing the volume of mucus that can be expelled by mucociliary action due to a reduction in the adhesiveness and viscosity of tenacious sputum. Thus providing relief to bronchial catarrh.

5.2 Pharmacokinetic properties

Salbutamol sulphate is rapidly and well absorbed following oral administration.

Peak plasma salbutamol concentrations occur within 2.5 and 2 hours following administration of the conventional tablets and oral solution respectively. Following oral administration of 2 mg of salbutamol every 6 hours as conventional tablets in healthy individuals, steady-state peak plasma salbutamol concentrations average 5.3-6.8 and steady-state trough plasma concentrations minutes 3.8-4.3ng/mL. Bronchodilation begins within 30 minutes after oral administration of conventional tablets, with peak effect in 2-3 hours, and may persist up to 4-6 hours.

Results of animal studies indicate that salbutamol does not cross the blood-brain barrier, but the drug apparently crosses the placenta. After oral administration, the plasma half-life is reportedly 2.7-5 hours.

Following oral administration of salbutamol sulphate to healthy individuals, about 75% of a single dose is excreted in urine within 72hours, mainly as the major metabolite; about 4% of the dose is excreted in feces.

Bromhexine hydrochloride is rapidly absorbed from the gastro-intestinal tract and about 85 to 90% of a dose is excreted in the urine mainly as metabolites of bromhexine. Bromhexine is highly bound to plasma proteins.

Guaifenesin is readily absorbed from the gastrointestinal tract after oral administration and rapidly metabolised by oxidation to beta-(2-methoxyphenoxy)-lactic acid. Within 3 hours, approximately 40% of a single dose is excreted in the urine as this metabolite. The half-life in plasma is approximately 1 hour.

Guaifenesin may increase the absorption rate of paracetamol, however the clinical relevance of this is unknown.

5.3 Preclinical safety data

There are no preclinical safety data of relevance to the consumer.

6 Pharmaceutical particulars

6.1 List of excipients

Levomenthyl/Menthol Crystal

Sodium Benzoate
Sodium Citrate
Citric Acid Anhydrous
Sodium Saccharin
Sucralose
Propylene Glycol
Hydroxy Propyl Methyl Cellulose (HPMC)
Cherry Flavour (Non-Alcohol base)
Carmoisine colour
Purified water

6.2 Incompatibilities

None stated.

6.3 Shelf life

24 months - unopened.

6.4 Special precautions for storage

Store below 30°C. Protect from light. Do not refrigerate. Keep out of the reach of children.

6.5 Nature and contents of container

60ml and 100ml amber PET bottle with white HDPE screw cap. A measuring cup is put on top of the capped bottle. The filled bottle is packed in a pre-printed carton.

6.6 Special precautions for disposal and other handling

No special requirements for disposal.

7 Marketing authorisation holder

KCK Pharmaceutical Industries Sdn. Bhd.
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8 Marketing authorisation number(s)

MAL

9 Date of first authorisation/renewal of the authorisation

10 Date of revision of the text

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